

The State of my Dots

Rohit Goswami · 2023-08-30 · ramblings · tools · workflow · config

Yet another post on provisioning machines with `dotfiles` ... now with `chezmoi`

Background

~~Barely two months ago~~ A few years ago, I wrote about moving away from the (now) python based `dots` to the rust based `toml-bombadil`. Unfortunately, the structure I backed myself into there was needlessly complicated, and involved manually making entries in the `bombadil.toml` file for each sub file. This was a good workflow in principle, since it enforces separation of concerns, but it was rather annoying in practice [^fn:1].

This post got sidelined a bunch of times over the years, as did a bunch of my work in progress posts, mostly because there were always some warts to be ironed out.

HPC Configurations

Around the same time as this post, I was writing up my trials and tribulations as a lowly user without admin access of the (then) new `elja` HPC cluster at the University of Iceland. Anyway, since HPC work (user / admin / whatever) is one of my main use-cases, this post could also be seen as a sequel of sorts to that one.

Dotfile management with `chezmoi`

`chezmoi` is almost an institution in and of itself, with detailed documentation and a plethora of users. Rather than go over the features of `chezmoi`, I'll outline the components of my `dotfiles` as they appear in the course of setting up a new user instance on a remote headless machine [^fn:2].

Conclusions

There's not a whole lot to say about the configuration. My setup has been fairly stable across a few systems with `chezmoi` but I haven't also really shifted machines very much. There are a few moving parts I wish were simpler, like setting up encryption, but `chezmoi` is the sort of fully loaded footgun one needs while adrift on a sea of random impersonal `/bin/bash` terminals.

Info

As an aside, there are **a lot** of backlogged posts I meant to get around to writing but no longer feel all that strongly about. Most of these are written up in the [original spirit of this blog]() (TL;DR: just write stuff down).